

CTF (Capture The Flag) Quick Guide for Hackathons

1. Web Challenges: Inspect source code, check robots.txt, use browser DevTools (F12), inspect JavaScript files and hidden comments.

2. Forensics: Analyze files, deleted data, USB images. Tools: Autopsy, strings, exiftool, binwalk, foremost.

Commands:

`strings image.png | grep flag`

`exiftool image.jpg`

`binwalk file.bin`

3. Steganography: Hidden data inside images/audio.

Tools: steghide, zsteg.

Commands: `steghide extract -sf image.jpg`

4. Cryptography: Decode Base64, ROT13, Caesar Cipher, hashes.

Example: `echo SGVsbG8= | base64 -d`

5. Reverse Engineering: Inspect executables.

Command: `strings file.exe`

6. Tools Checklist: Kali Linux, Burp Suite, CyberChef, Autopsy, Wireshark, exiftool, steghide, binwalk.

7. Hackathon Strategy:

- Read challenge carefully
- Search for hints
- Document findings
- Try easy challenges first
- Save flags and notes